

Delaware County Council Meeting August 27th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Leu8asl3uzs
Publication Date	2024-08-27T16:28:40Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Council Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: August / September (Annual Budget & Legislative Session)

Governing Body: Delaware County Council

Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate committee work session was held immediately prior to the call to order. The meeting proceeded directly to the regular agenda.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer (President Piper) called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Flanigan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. K, Mr. Mel, Mr. Webb, Mr. Whitehead, and Miss Piper (President).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Miss Piper (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Standard procedural opening; no invocation or formal Pledge of Allegiance transcriptions were recorded.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Handled via regular procedural motions during the meeting's administrative block.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Transfers and Appropriations

- **00:05:30 County General <U+2013> Jail (Fund 145):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor's Office / Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding transferring excess funds from unfilled correctional officer salary lines into overtime (\$25,000) and holiday pay (\$4,592) to manage shift minimum staffing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:09:24 County General <U+2013> Sheriff (Fund 129):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff<U+2019>s Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocation of unspent salary lines due to staff turnover and new hires attending the academy, shifting funds into overtime (\$76,616) and holiday pay (\$24,493).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:16:23 County General <U+2013> Assessor (Fund 134):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** James Carmichael, County Assessor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer from Personal Mobile Home salaries (due to an employment gap) to office supplies (\$3,000) to purchase an accommodating desk for an employee working with large plats.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:17:51 County General <U+2013> Treasurer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Treasurer's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$2,500 from printing advertising to equipment to purchase two additional cashier computers ahead of November tax collections.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:18:44 Juvenile Detention Alternative Initiative (JDAI) Grant (Fund 90107):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating \$4,500 from Professional/Contractual Services (300 series) into supplies (200 series) as stipulated by updated grant approvals.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:21:55 County General <U+2013> Communications (Fund 124):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Department (Fred).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocation of salary savings into holiday pay (\$14,000) and overtime (\$35,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:24:05 County General <U+2013> Clerk:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Clerk's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$1,500 from office supplies to equipment to replace broken document scanners.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:25:15 EMS (Fund 155):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS Director / Megan Cino.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating \$31,000 from Advanced EMT salary lines into overtime to cover intensive shift hours, severe weather events (tornado/eclipse), and mutual aid coverage.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).
- **00:36:33 County General <U+2013> Communications (Fund 124 - Second Addendum):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Additional adjustment moving \$20,000 from comp lines to holiday (\$5,000) and overtime (\$15,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call passed unanimously (7-0).

Additional Appropriations

- **00:37:39 County General <U+2013> Public Defender (Fund 139):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office / Sam Beasley / Shelley Harvey.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$50,000 for attorney fees and \$20,000 for transcription fees (totaling \$70,000). Driven by a surge in jury trials involving murders and Level 1 felonies (specifically "dealing resulting in death" charges) and a record number of appeals (18 to date). Note: 40% reimbursable by the Indiana Public Defender Commission.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **00:50:58 County General <U+2013> Auditor (Fund 126):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya Dunmore, Chief Deputy Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Original request for \$50,000 for contractual services (covering Baker Tilly accounting, software contracts, and highway payroll time clocks). Council members debated high consulting costs and utility software expenses.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Amended** via motion by Bill Hughes, seconded by Matt, to reduce the appropriation to **\$30,000**. Approved as amended on a roll call vote (6-1, with Mr. Webb voting "No").
- **03:13:12 County General <U+2013> Data (Fund 120):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim / Tanya Dunmore.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$39,431 for implementation and licensing costs related to the new SSI employee portal and HR module, signed in late 2023 after budget adoption.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (6-1, with Mr. Webb voting "No").
- **01:19:55 Public Defender Supplemental Fund (Fund 247):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$1,050 for equipment (desktop computer for a newly hired investigator). 40% reimbursable.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:21:52 MVH Restricted Fund (Fund 1173):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tommy Humber, Highway Department / Carrie.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$975,000 for contractual services dedicated to major county road paving and maintenance projects (utilizing MVH restricted funds and Community Crossing matching grants). Roads include sections of Wheeling Ave, 28 to Road, Cow Road, 850 North, and others.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:31:28 Community Crossing Grant Fund (Additional):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Acceptance and appropriation of additional Community Crossing matching grant funds for road improvements.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:34:11 Juvenile DOC Grant (Fund 819):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$98,610 for a brand-new Department of Correction grant funding a juvenile probation officer position and GPS monitoring services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:37:11 County Sales Disclosure (Fund 113):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor's Office.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Original request of \$2,300 for conference and training. Reduced following guidance from the Auditor's office.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended to \$700. Approved as amended by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:39:41 County Drug Free Community Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jennifer Lavelle Moore, Executive Director of Delaware County Prevention Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$2,595 representing generated drug/alcohol infraction fees to be disbursed as grants for local prevention, education, and justice reform.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:41:09 EMS Ambulance Replacement Fund (Fund 491):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$114,880 for vehicle/chassis replacement (re-chassing an ambulance ordered in Sept 2023).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:43:06 EMS Capital Improvement Fund (Fund 4910):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Corrected total appropriation of \$115,666.49 for capital outlays.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).
- **01:35:51 Delco Cumulative Building Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Building Commission / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$3,000 for operating supplies (security badge printer heads, ribbons, and badges). Council discussed an unutilized balance of roughly \$65,000 originating from a legacy tax.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call (7-0).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments from residents regarding industrial solar farm proposals and agricultural preservation in Delaware County.)

- **02:33:11 Ron Crouch:** Expressed deep concern regarding lack of transparency over a National Grid project, drone surveying over his property, and the encroachment of industrial solar projects on agricultural land.
- **02:36:38 Melinda Crouch:** Voiced strong opposition to solar farm installations surrounding residential properties, highlighting studies on declining property values and potential tax exemption risks if sold to public utilities.

- **02:40:13 Autumn Grismore:** Highlighted health, safety, and welfare concerns regarding utility-scale solar farms and urged updates to local county ordinances.
 - **02:42:18 Mike Johnson:** Shared emotional concerns over losing rural serenity and property value due to proposed solar developments near his home.
 - **02:45:36 Mallerie P.:** Called for a moratorium on industrial solar projects in Delaware County and criticized local officials regarding economic development priorities.
 - **02:48:11 Janet Garen:** Presented data from the American Farmland Trust and Michigan State University (Miller Study) emphasizing Delaware County's status as prime agricultural land and the economic drawbacks of displacing farming revenue.
 - **02:52:00 Christopher Bilbury:** Criticized county leadership transparency and urged council members to actively address constituent concerns regarding solar developments and accountability.
 - **02:54:50 Tommy Humber (County Highway Supervisor):** Spoke briefly in support of the Council's collaborative relationship with the highway department.
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Annual Budget Hearings are scheduled to begin Wednesday morning of the following week, continuing into Thursday.
 - The next regular County Council meeting is scheduled for **Tuesday, September 24th, at 9:00 A.M.**
 - **Other Board Actions:**
 - Job descriptions second reading was **tabled** to allow further review of FLSA status classifications and specific departmental roles (Clerk, Public Health Nurse, and Highway Supervisor/Superintendent).
 - Estimated property tax cap impact report and Max Levy received **no recommendation of review**, a standard procedural vote.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn approved by unanimous voice/roll call vote.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-03 06:15:44 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.